

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1042

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the eightieth anniversary of
Philippine-American Friendship Day.

WHEREAS, this year marks the eightieth anniversary of the United States-Philippines diplomatic relationship, beginning in 1946 with the formal recognition of the Philippines' independence through the Treaty of Manila; and

WHEREAS, that recognition of independence came after World War II, and the Philippines and the United States worked together to expel the Japanese occupation of the island through joint efforts by American forces, the Philippine Commonwealth Army, the Philippine Scouts, the Philippine Constabulary, and everyday citizens fighting back; and

WHEREAS, beginning in 1946, the two sovereign nations began a new chapter built on shared ideals of freedom, dignity, and democracy; and

WHEREAS, this eightieth anniversary occasion will include year-long programming across both countries to celebrate and showcase the unwavering ties between the Philippines and the United States as friends, partners, and allies; and

WHEREAS, our two nations have grown this partnership into one of the most enduring in the modern world, whose foundation is rooted in opportunity, growth, and mutual prosperity; and

WHEREAS, the Philippines is the United States' second oldest treaty ally in Asia and the longest, oldest, and strongest United States security alliance in the Indo-Pacific region; and

WHEREAS, the United States and the Philippines routinely work together to advance strategic initiatives related to security, trade, energy, sciences, public health, regional cooperation, and technological innovation; and

WHEREAS, through challenge and change, the United States and the Philippines have stood together, bound by trust and strengthened through sacrifice; and

WHEREAS, Philippine-American Friendship Day is a joyous occasion that celebrates the strong bond and enduring camaraderie between the Philippines and the United States; and

WHEREAS, at first, July 4, 1946, was designated as the Philippines Independence Day, but later, then-President Diosdado Macapagal moved the Philippines Independence Day celebration to June 12, renaming July 4 as the Philippine Republic Day, or Philippine-American Friendship Day; and

WHEREAS, our partnership across the Pacific showcases the importance of collective effort, cooperation, and helping one another; and

WHEREAS, Philippine-American Friendship Day provides an opportunity to remember the sacrifices and solidarity that have shaped the diplomatic relationship between the two nations and to look forward to continued friendship, peace, steadfast partnership, common purpose, and shared prosperity; and

WHEREAS, the historic people-to-people ties are the bedrock of the United States-Philippines relationship, with around 375,000 Americans calling the Philippines home, while more than 4.6 million Filipinos and Filipino-Americans live, work, and study across the United States; and

WHEREAS, these individuals compose living bridges connecting our communities to each other and have been sustained and strengthened across generations; and

WHEREAS, the Filipino population in Tennessee exceeds 30,000, making it the third-largest Asian ethnic group in the State, and this vibrant community enriches the civic, cultural, and economic life of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we commemorate the eightieth anniversary of Philippine-American Friendship Day, recognize the enduring partnership between the Republic of the Philippines and

the United States of America, and extend our appreciation to the Filipino community in Tennessee for its many contributions to this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.